

Project Title: Smiths Ferry Trail & Conservation Project Part 1

Applicant Name: Ohio River Trail Council

Grant Opportunity: Acquisition - Open Space; Critical Habitat; Recreation

Web ID: 1100298

Date Submitted: 4/16/2015 11:15:39 AM

Project Introduction

Web ID	1100298
Project Title	Smiths Ferry Trail & Conservation Project Part 1
Grant Opportunity	Acquisition
Project Type(s)	Open Space; Critical Habitat; Recreation
Major Watershed(s)	Ohio
Attended grant workshop?	Yes
Contacted regional advisor?	Yes
Advisor	Adam Mattis

General Application Details

Project Applicant	Ohio River Trail Council
Federal ID	35-2366103
Vendor ID	765870
Address Line 1	1100 PENNSYLVANIA AVE
Address Line 2	
City	MONACA
State	PA
Zip Code	15061-1830
Organizational DUNS	8311192140000
County	Beaver
Municipality	Ohioville Boro

Applicant Type Details

Applicant Type	Private Non-Profit
501(c)(3) Organization Name	Ohio River Trail Council
501(c)(3) Organization Approval Date	11/09/2009
Charitable Organization Name	
Charitable Registration Number	
Charitable Expiration Date	

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Project Coordinator Details

Linked Project Coordinator

Organization	Ohio River Trail Council
Title	President & CEO
Prefix	Dr.
First Name	Vincent
Middle Initial	
Last Name	Troia
Suffix	
Address Line 1	1100 Pennsylvania Av
Address Line 2	
City	Monaca
State	PA
Zip Code	15061-1830
Phone	(724) 728-2625
Cell	(724) 462-3183
Fax	(724) 775-9876
Email	drvtrioa@ohiorivertrail.org

Chief Elected Official Details

Linked Chief Elected Official

Organization	Ohio River Trail Council
Title	President & CEO
Prefix	Dr.
First Name	Vincent
Middle Initial	
Last Name	Troia
Suffix	
Address Line 1	1100 Pennsylvania Av
Address Line 2	
City	Monaca
State	PA
Zip Code	15061-1830
Phone	(724) 728-2625
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Project Information

Property Owned?**Property Leased?** No**Fee Acquisition?** Yes**Conservation Easement?** No**Known Environmental Hazards?** No**Acquired or Severed Rights**

Sales Agreement calls for the purchase of 69.85 acres located in Ohioville Borough while the seller retains any oil, gas and mineral rights attached to the property.

Project Start Date 04/07/2014**Project End Date** 12/31/2015**Brief Project Description**

The project goal is to provide a riparian buffer, expand Lock 57 Community Park, an IBA, and protect a threatened Salamander. The Smiths Ferry Trail is also a key component of the Ohio River Greenway Trail, Great Ohio-Lake-to-River Greenway, and the Industrial Heartland Trail's Cleveland/Ashtabula to Pittsburgh Trail. This grant will be utilized to purchase of 69.85 acres. A sales agreement is under contract for \$210,000 with an appraised value of \$224,000.

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Project Location Details

Location 1

Location Details Link: [Location 1](#)

Latitude	40.65121657	Address Line 1	
Longitude	-80.51482126	Address Line 2	
Acreage	60.65	City	Ohioville
Length in Miles		State	PA
Parcel Number	711700113. P00	Zip Code	15059
Is the property leased?	No	Description	Location 1
Property Owner	H. Richard Lewis		
Counties			

Beaver

Municipalities

Beaver - Ohioville Boro

PA House Districts

PA House - 14 - Jim Marshall

PA Senate Districts

PA Senate - 47 - Elder A. Vogel Jr.

U.S. Congressional Districts

U.S. Congressional - 12 - Keith Rothfus

Location Attachments

- [Location1-Parcel 71-170-0113.pdf](#)

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Location 2

Location Details Link: [Location 2](#)

Latitude	40.65058814	Address Line 1	
Longitude	-80.51555083	Address Line 2	
Acreage	8.00	City	Ohioville
Length in Miles		State	PA
Parcel Number	711700113.002	Zip Code	15059
Is the property leased?	No	Description	Location 2
Property Owner	H. Richard Lewis		

Counties

Beaver

Municipalities

Beaver - Ohioville Boro

PA House Districts

PA House - 14 - Jim Marshall

PA Senate Districts

PA Senate - 47 - Elder A. Vogel Jr.

U.S. Congressional Districts

U.S. Congressional - 12 - Keith Rothfus

Location Attachments

- [Location2-Parcel 71-170-0113.pdf](#)

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Location 3

Location Details Link: [Location 3](#)

Latitude	40.64755902	Address Line 1	
Longitude	-80.51192931	Address Line 2	
Acreage	1.20	City	
Length in Miles		State	PA
Parcel Number	711700118.000	Zip Code	15059
Is the property leased?	No	Description	Location 3
Property Owner	H. Richard Lewis		

Counties

Beaver

Municipalities

Beaver - Ohioville Boro

PA House Districts

PA House - 14 - Jim Marshall

PA Senate Districts

PA Senate - 47 - Elder A. Vogel Jr.

U.S. Congressional Districts

U.S. Congressional - 12 - Keith Rothfus

Location Attachments

- [Location3-Parcel 71-170-0118.pdf](#)

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Project Narrative

Project Needs and Benefits

The project goal is to preserve critical habitat areas, and open space as well as develop park, recreation areas, and greenways.

This picturesque critical habitat and open space area abuts the Ohio State border and is located in Ohioville, Pa. Steep walls, wooded slopes, sandstone hills, and high rock cliffs characterize the foothills of the Appalachian Mountains. From ridges topping over 200 feet, there are breathtaking views of the deep valley below. The space to be conserved provides a riparian buffer and borders the Little Beaver Creek, which flows through some of Ohio and Pennsylvania's most rugged and wildest lands and is located near the confluence of the Ohio River. Geologically, the valley of the Little Beaver is unique, being the only stream valley in the United States, in which evidence of all four major glaciations can be found.

A number of classifications protects the Little Beaver Creek with its numerous gentle rapids, including Ohio Wild and Scenic River and National Scenic River, as well as being part of Ohio's state park system. It is the only major river in Ohio to have dual State Wild and Scenic and National Scenic River designations. The Little Beaver Creek ecosystem supports 63 species of fish, 49 mammal species, 140 types of birds and 46 species of reptiles and amphibians. The Little Beaver Creek watershed is home to Beaver Creek State Forest, Beaver Creek State Park, and Sheepskin Hollow State Nature Preserve.

The flora of this area contains several interesting and unusual species. Canada yew, yellow and black birch, hemlock, and mountain laurel. The stream banks are lined with delicate wildflowers including jewelweed, hepatica, violets and spring beauties. Many types of wildlife find the varying habitats inviting including red fox, skunk, raccoon, wild turkey, and white-tailed deer.

This site has the opportunity to expand an adjacent Audubon Important Bird Area. Deep hemlock gorges surround and protect Little Beaver Creek, providing nesting-site habitat for ducks, songbirds, woodpeckers, owls, hawks and many other birds. The habitat provides ample food, water and a safe area to raise their young. The IBA helps form a corridor that is a vital stopover link for migrating songbirds.

The IBA harbors Canadian-zone species and is a top five site for Blue-headed Vireo, Black-throated Green Warbler, Yellow-throated Warbler, Prairie Warbler, Cerulean Warbler, and Worm-eating Warbler. It is also a specialty site for Northern Parula and Red-breasted Nuthatch. Moreover, it is the only Ohio confirmed breeding site for Common Merganser. It also remains a potential Black-throated Blue Warbler breeding site.

Little Beaver Creek is also home to the threatened Eastern Hellbender Salamander (*Cryptobranchus alleganiensis*), which is limited to a relatively few healthy stream systems, mainly in areas that have remained isolated from development and urbanization. They can reach twenty-nine inches in length and weigh up to five pounds. Scientists estimate that they can live for up to 30 to 50 years.

Research throughout the range of the hellbender has shown a dramatic decline in populations in the majority of locations. Hellbenders are especially sensitive to water pollution because they breathe through their skin. Other anthropogenic sources have helped to create this decline, including the siltation and sedimentation, blocking of dispersal/migration routes, and destruction of riverine habitats created by dams and other development. As many of these detrimental effects have irreversibly damaged hellbender populations, it is important to conserve the remaining populations through protecting habitats.

Ohio's largest population of the endangered Hellbender salamanders resides in Little Beaver Creek. The Ohio Division of Wildlife lists the Hellbender as endangered. Hellbenders are an important part of the Little Beaver Creek ecosystem.

With respect to the development of park, recreation areas, and greenways, this parcel would expand Ohioville's Lock 57 Community Park, which lies across Little Beaver Creek. In 1848, the Sandy and Beaver Canal utilizing the Little Beaver Creek linked the Ohio River with the Ohio & Erie Canal. Remnants of the once thriving canal system are well preserved throughout the region. The Lock 54 remnant in Pennsylvania is within hiking distance of this parcel. Lock 57 Park, Beaver Creek State Park, Pennsylvania State Game Lands #173, and nearby Beaver Creek State Forest provide opportunities for where visitors can enjoy camping, fishing, horseback riding and picnicking. Stream fishing

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in the Little Beaver Creek is excellent for smallmouth bass and rock bass.

The Smiths Ferry Trail & Conservation Project Part One is a portion of the Ohio River Greenway Trail, which is a 41-mile trail project that interconnects the Montour Trail in Allegheny County, Pennsylvania to the Little Beaver Creek Greenway in Columbiana County, Ohio. The planned greenway project also parallels the existing Ohio River Water Trail, which includes Little Beaver Creek. The greenway and blueway ultimately will form a wonderful pedal & paddle recreational system.

The Smiths Ferry Trail is also a key component of the Great Ohio Lake-to-River Greenway and the regional Industrial Heartland Trail Coalition's Cleveland/Ashtabula – Pittsburgh Trail.

The project is located in the Rivers of Steel National Heritage Area, which is committed to preserving, interpreting, and managing the historic, cultural, and natural resources related to Big Steel and its related industries.

The Smiths Ferry Trail is a rails-to-trails project, which utilizes the abandoned Youngstown & Southern Railway Smiths Ferry Branch. The Consolidated Coal Company, successor to the Pittsburgh Coal Company, built a private railroad, which was operated by the Youngstown & Southern Railway from the Ohio River at Smiths Ferry, Pennsylvania to Negley, Ohio. Its purpose was to move large amounts of bituminous coal brought in from the mines on Ohio River ferries to the Smiths Ferry transfer facilities and transported inland to a coal washing facility at Negley, Ohio. After being processed, the coal was shipped by rail to the Republic Steel Corporation in Youngstown, Ohio. Operations decreased with those of the steel industry and the Negley-Smiths Ferry line track was removed in 1996.

This grant will be utilized by the ORTC to purchase of 69.85 acres owned by H. Richard Lewis. A sales agreement is under contract for \$210,000 with an appraised value of \$224,000.

Relationship of your Project to State, Regional, County and/or Local Plans and Public Engagement

The Smiths Ferry Trail & Conservation project advances the goals of Beaver County's recreation and open space plans. County officials support the efforts of local, regional, and state partners, both public and private, to implement an interconnected system of greenways and natural open spaces. A number of public meetings have been held and are planned during the development of the greenway.

Beaver County Greenway and Trails Plan

http://files.beavercountypa.gov/PublicServices/PlanningCommission/PDFs/Greenway_trail_plan.pdf

Page 51 Map 7.

Page 54 #3. The Beaver to Ohio Trail

Page 55 Map 7A.

Ohio River North Shore Trail Feasibility Study

<http://www.greenway.ohiorivertrail.org/index.php/orgt-north-shore-feasibility-study>

Page II.1 to II.6 (Section 100)

Pennsylvania Major Trail Gap #242

<http://www.paoutdoorrecplan.com/trailgaps/index.htm>

Great Ohio Lake-to-River Greenway

<http://www.eastgatecog.org/GOLTRG.aspx>

Industrial Heartland Trails Coalition

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Project Partners and Commitment

The project is supported by Beaver County and the Borough of Ohioville in Pennsylvania as well as Columbiana County and the Great Ohio lake-to-River Greenway Coalition in Ohio.

Sustainable and Green Practices

The Smiths Ferry Trail & Conservation project will consult an experienced design team to complete the following goals. The project will minimize impacts or changes to the natural landscape (e.g. steep slopes, hillsides, tree cover, rock outcroppings, native vegetation, soil structure, etc.). Protect and restore systems associated with a site's hydrology and sensitive ecosystems. Promote natural stormwater infiltration through installation of rain gardens, bio-swales, naturalized detention basins, etc. Use permeable surfaces for pathways, parking lots, overlooks, etc. Incorporate proper drainage and design. Restore or enhance riparian areas and buffers along rivers, streams, creeks, lakes, rivers, etc. Control erosion through buffer stabilization. Protect, enhance or repair wetlands, floodplains, seasonal pools, streams or headwater areas. Protect and restore site vegetation, species and habitat.

The project will plant new native trees, whenever possible. Landscaping is incorporated into project, using native plants, shrubs, trees, in swales, rain gardens or other planted areas to keep invasive plants from reestablishing. Invasive plants will be managed and controlled on site. The project will protect critical habitat for threatened or endangered species. The project will protect environmentally sensitive lands for health, habitat, and biodiversity through this conservation acquisition. The ORTC will build healthy communities and teach environmental stewardship. Provide opportunities for passive recreation and interaction with nature via the greenway, nature paths, meadow trails, and viewing areas. Provide opportunities for children to participate in activities in a natural environment. Provide opportunities to connect with scenic overlooks. The project will install interpretive signage and/or develop programming that educates visitors about interesting features, habitats and sustainable practices within the area. The ORTC will foster sense of responsibility and stewardship ethic by users utilizing volunteer maintenance days, clean-up days, restore vegetation workdays, friends of park groups, etc.).

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Project Budget Details

Cash Costs

Contracted/Professional Services

Contracted Professional Service or Task	Estimated Cost
Appraisal	\$1,600.00
	\$1,600.00

Land/Easement Purchase Cash Costs

Description of Costs	Number of Acres	Total Cash Cost
69.85 acres in three parcels located in Ohioville Borough		\$213,950.00
		\$213,950.00

Cash Costs Total: \$215,550.00

Non-Cash Costs

Donated Land Value

Description of Property	Total Value
	\$0.00

Non-Cash Costs Total: \$0.00

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Project Match Information

Name of Match Source	Cash Amount	Pending (P) or Secured (S)	Non-Cash Value	Pending (P) or Secured (S)
Beaver County	\$106,475.00	P		N/A
ORTC	\$1,600.00	S		N/A
ORTC	\$1,000.00	S		N/A
	\$109,075.00		\$0.00	Total: \$109,075.00

Amount		Amount	
Cash Amount Secured	\$2,600.00	Cash Amount Pending	\$106,475.00
Non-Cash Amount Secured	\$0.00	Non-Cash Amount Pending	\$0.00
Total Secured	\$2,600.00	Total Pending	\$106,475.00
		Total Cash and Non-Cash	\$109,075.00
		Match Percentage	50.60%
		(of Total Project Cost)	

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Project Budget Summary

Budget Category	Cash Costs	Non-Cash Values	Total
Contracted/Professional Services	\$1,600.00	-	\$1,600.00
Land/Easement Purchase Cash Costs	\$213,950.00	-	\$213,950.00
Donated Land Value	-	\$0.00	\$0.00
	\$215,550.00 (100%)	\$0.00 (0%)	\$215,550.00 (100%) Total Project Cost

DCNR Grant Request: \$106,657.50

Overall Budget & Match Summary

Project Totals	Amount
Total Project Cost (Detailed Budget)	\$215,550.00
Total Project Match	\$109,075.00
DCNR Grant Request	\$106,657.50
Total Project Funding	\$215,732.50

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Agricultural Land Preservation Policy

Is the project site in active agricultural use (not including the growing of timber)?

No

Has the project site been devoted to active agricultural use during the last three years?

No

Is the site considered "prime agricultural land" as defined in E.O. 2003-2?

No

Will the project cause an irreversible conversion of "prime agricultural land"?

Is this the only feasible site available for the project?

Narrative explanation

Pennsylvania Natural Diversity Inventory (PNDI) Receipt

Pennsylvania Natural Diversity Inventory (PNDI) Receipt Uploaded?

Yes

Public Value and Use

The public values to be protected by the project. Examples of public values include but are not limited to critical habitat protection, habitat connectivity, water quality benefits, etc.

The key public values to be protected by the project is the critical habitat protection for the endangered Hellbender Salamander, provide a riparian buffer, and to preserve a designated Important Bird Area.

The types of uses planned for the property or areas of the property and any restrictions (upload a map). Examples of uses include activities like: Walking, hiking, bird watching, fishing, hunting, etc. Explain any resource protection based and other constraints to uses planned for the property.

The project planned uses for the property include the development of park facilities, recreation areas, and trails thereby granting opportunities for birding, butterflying, deer spotting, fishing, and enjoying the spring wildflowers or the peak autumn colors.

Project Resolution

Appointed Title

President & CEO

Resolution Uploaded?

Yes

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Grant Agreement Signature

Grant Agreement Signature Page Uploaded?

Yes

Project Attachments

Uploaded Project Files

- [AppraisalReports_ORTC-HR-Lewis-Real-Estate-Appraisal-2015.pdf](#)
- [Beaver-County-Greenways-and-Trail-Plan-Map-17-2007.pdf](#)
- [Columbiana-County-Ohio-Proposed-Trails.pdf](#)
- [CountyMunicipalNotificationLetters_ORTC_Letter to Beaver County Planning Commission - Lewis Property.pdf](#)
- [CountyMunicipalNotificationLetters_ORTC_Letter to Ohioville - Lewis Property.pdf](#)
- [DraftSalesAgreement_ORTC-Draft-HR-Lewis-Real-Estate-Agreement-2015.pdf](#)
- [Eastern-Hellbenders-North-American-Range.pdf](#)
- [Future-Ohio-River-Trail-Smiths-Ferry-Branch-Ohioville-Pa-Photo-Credit-Dr-Vincent-Troia.pdf](#)
- [GrantAgreementSignaturePage_ORTC-DCNR-Grant-Agreement-Signature-Page-1100298.pdf](#)
- [Great-Ohio-Lake-to-River-Greenway-Trail-Pa-Connections.pdf](#)
- [LettersOfCashNonCashCommitment_ORTC_Letters of Cash-Non-Cash Commitment.pdf](#)
- [Lewis-Beaverkettle-Farms-Kenny-Ohioville-Properties.pdf](#)
- [Little-Beaver-Creek-HR-Lewis-Shoreline-Vincent-Troia-2014.pdf](#)
- [Little-Beaver-Creek-Kayaking-with-View-of-Smiths-Ferry-Trail-Shoreline-Vincent-Troia-08-23-2014.pdf](#)
- [Location1-Parcel 71-170-0113.pdf](#)
- [Location2-Parcel 71-170-0113.pdf](#)
- [Location3-Parcel 71-170-0118.pdf](#)
- [Major-Trail-Gaps-of-Pennsylvania-Ohio-River-Trail-242.pdf](#)
- [National-Audubon-Society-Important-Bird-Area-Little-Beaver-Creek-Map.pdf](#)
- [ODOT-Trails-Map-North-East.pdf](#)
- [Ohio-River-Water-Trail-Map.pdf](#)
- [ORTC-Ed-Kline-HR-Lewis-Appraisal-Invoice-01-26-2015.pdf](#)
- [ORTC-HR-Lewis-Property-Buyers-Estimated-Costs-and-Deposit-Money-Notice.pdf](#)
- [ORTC-LOS-Columbiana-County-Park-District-Smiths-Ferry-Trail.pdf](#)
- [ORTC-LOS-GOLTRG-Smiths-Ferry-Trail.pdf](#)
- [ORTC-LOS-Midland-Pa-Smiths-Ferry-Trail.pdf](#)
- [ORTC-LOS-Representative-Jim-Marshall-Smiths-Ferry-Trail.pdf](#)
- [ORTC-LOS-Western Pennsylvania Conservancy-Smiths-Ferry-Trail.pdf](#)
- [ORTC-ORGT-CONNECTION-T0-GOLR_MAP.pdf](#)
- [ORTC-ORGT-North-Shore-Feasibility-Study-Map.pdf](#)
- [Pa-Eastern-Hellbender-Historic-Map.pdf](#)
- [Pennsylvania-Rivers-of-Steel-National-Heritage-Area.pdf](#)
- [PNDIReceipt_ORTC Smiths Ferry Trail & Conservation Area Project Part 1 PNDI Test Receipt.pdf](#)
- [ProjectSiteLocationMap_H R Lewis Ohioville Properties Map.pdf](#)
- [Proposed-Conservation-Area-Lewis-Property-Ohioville-Pa-Vincent-Troia-2014-1200.pdf](#)
- [Resolution_ORTC-DCNR-Resolution-Smiths-Ferry-Trail-Project-Part-1.pdf](#)
- [SalesAgreement_ORTC-HR-Lewis-Real-Estate-Agreement-2015.pdf](#)
- [Smiths-Ferry-Trail-&-Conservation-Area-June-2011-Photo-Vincent-Troia.jpg](#)
- [SurveyOrTaxMap_HR Lewis Parcels.pdf](#)
- [Youngstown-&-Southern-Railway-Map-1948.pdf](#)

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Authorized Representative

Title	President & CEO
Prefix	Dr.
First Name	Vincent
Middle Initial	
Last Name	Troia
Suffix	
Address Line 1	1100 Pennsylvania Av
Address Line 2	
City	Monaca
State	PA
Zip Code	15061-1830
Phone	(724) 728-2625
Cell	(724) 462-3183
Fax	(724) 775-9876
Email	drvtroia@ohiorivertrail.org